Inclusive Course Design Checklist Aligned with WCAG 2.1

Inclusive courses start here

WCAG Compliance Checklist

1. Compliance Overview

Objective:
Ensure that the *Inclusive eLearning Practices* course follows WCAG 2.1 Level AA and serves as a model for educators to create accessible and inclusive courses. This checklist guides educators in applying practical accessibility principles to their own course materials.

Responsible Party: *Inclusive eLearning Practices* Development Team

Date of Last Review: October 14,2025

Next Scheduled Review: April 28, 2026

2. Accessibility Statement

Inclusive eLearning Practices is committed to creating digital learning experiences that are accessible to all educators and learners. This course demonstrates how small, practical design choices—such as clear headings, alt text, captions, and high-contrast visuals—make courses more inclusive.

Educators can apply these same principles to their own course materials. By following WCAG 2.1 Level AA standards and Universal Design for Learning (UDL) principles, educators can create learning environments that are accessible, supportive of neurodiverse learners, and beneficial for all students.

3. General Accessibility

- [ ] Ensure all content is perceivable, operable, understandable, and robust.

- [ ] Implement text alternatives for non-text content such as images, videos, and audio.
- [ ] Provide alternatives for time-based media, such as captions for videos and transcripts for audio content.
- [ ] Ensure all functionality is accessible via keyboard and does not require mouse interaction.
- [ ] Avoid using color as the sole method of conveying information.
- [ ] Support neurodiverse learners by allowing adjustments for **font size, spacing, and line height**, as well as **high-contrast or low-stimulus themes**.

4. Perceivable

- [ ] Provide text alternatives for all non-text content.
- [ ] Ensure all images have descriptive alt text.
- [ ] Use descriptive headings and labels for forms and interactive elements.
- [ ] Provide captions and transcripts for all multimedia content.
- [ ] Ensure content can be presented in multiple ways without losing meaning or structure.
- [ ] Support simplified layouts or “focus modes” to reduce cognitive load.

5. Operable

- [ ] Ensure all functionality is available from a keyboard.
- [ ] Provide sufficient time for users to read and use content.
- [ ] Avoid content that flashes more than three times per second.
- [ ] Implement clear and consistent navigation throughout the LMS.
- [ ] Make interactive elements predictable and easy to use.
- [ ] Provide controls to **pause, stop, or adjust playback speed** for time-based media.
- [ ] Offer alternative ways to complete tasks (e.g., multiple-choice instead of drag-and-drop).
- [ ] Avoid unnecessary animations, auto-play content, or moving elements that may cause sensory overload.

6. Understandable

- [ ] Use clear and simple language throughout the LMS.
- [ ] Ensure all content is organized in a logical manner.
- [ ] Provide instructions, cues, and guidance to help users understand how to interact with content.
- [ ] Avoid jargon and complex language where possible.
- [ ] Ensure error messages are clear and easy to understand.
- [ ] Include **tooltips, hints, or guided prompts** to assist navigation.
- [ ] Offer **checklists, progress indicators, and step-by-step guidance**.
- [ ] Maintain consistent and predictable UI patterns for cognitive clarity..

7. Robust

- [ ] Use valid HTML and CSS to ensure compatibility with assistive technologies.
- [ ] Ensure compatibility with a wide range of browsers and devices.
- [ ] Test the LMS with different assistive technologies, including screen readers, magnifiers, and voice recognition tools.
- [ ] Keep content up to date and regularly review for accessibility issues.
- [ ] Provide a feedback mechanism for users to report accessibility issues.
- [ ] Enable users to **bookmark content, create personal notes, and track progress**.
- [ ] Implement ARIA roles correctly for dynamic content and interactive elements.
- [ ] Ensure seamless integration with text-to-speech and speech-to-text technologies.

8. Testing and Evaluation

- [ ] Conduct regular accessibility audits using **automated tools and manual testing**.
- [ ] Involve users with disabilities in usability testing to identify barriers and improve accessibility.
- [ ] Test with a variety of assistive technologies, including **screen readers, magnifiers, and voice recognition software**.
- [ ] Document accessibility findings and remediation efforts for future reference.
- [ ] Include testing specifically for **neurodiverse-friendly features**, such as focus mode, customizable layouts, and simplified navigation.

9. Educator Guidance for Accessibility

- [ ] Use accessibility best practices when creating and uploading course materials.
- [ ] Ensure content is perceivable, operable, understandable, and robust for all students.
- [ ] Provide alternatives for non-text content (alt text for images, captions or transcripts for audio/video).
- [ ] Offer multiple ways for students to engage with materials (e.g., text, audio, visual).
- [ ] Be aware of neurodiverse-friendly practices, such as simplified layouts, consistent structure, and optional focus modes.
- [ ] Provide clear instructions, checklists, and progress indicators to support student understanding.
- [ ] Encourage feedback from students about accessibility or usability barriers.

10. Acknowledgment

By checking the box below, you confirm that you have reviewed and understand the contents of this WCAG accessibility checklist and will apply its guidance to your course materials.

☐ I have reviewed this accessibility checklist and will apply its guidance to my course materials.